

Motherboards

Motherboard

The principal PCB assembly in a computer; includes the core logic (chipset), interface sockets and/or slots, and input/output (I/O) ports.

Printed Circuit Board (PCB)

A thin, laminated sheet composed of a series of epoxy resin and copper layers and etched electronic circuits (signal, ground and power).

Chipset (Core logic)

Two or more integrated circuits that control the interfaces between the system processor, RAM, I/O devices and adapter cards.

Processor Slot/socket

The slot or socket used to mount the system processor on the motherboard.

AGP (Accelerated Graphics Port)

A high-speed interface for video cards.

PCI (Peripheral Component Interconnect)

A high-speed interface for video cards, sound cards, network interface cards, and modems; runs at 33 MHz.

ISA (Industry Standard Architecture)

A relatively low-speed interface primarily used for sound cards and modems; runs at approximately 8 MHz.

Port

An interface connector for devices.

Serial Port

A low-speed interface typically used for mice and external modems.